

ATTITUDE: CONTENT, STRUCTURE AND PERSUASION

THE ABC MODEL: WHAT... → HOW ATTITUDES FORM: EXPERIENCE... → HOVLAND-YALE PERSUASION: SOURCE, MESSAGE... → COGNITIVE DISSONANCE: THREE PATHS... → THE ATTITUDE-BEHAVIOUR GAP: WHY... → PERSUASION, MANIPULATION AND PROPAGANDA...

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 THE ABC MODEL: WHAT ATTITUDE IS MADE OF

THE ABC MODEL WHAT ATTITUDE IS MADE OF CENTRAL FOCUS 1. THE ABC MODEL [1] ATTITUDE IS A STABLE EVALUATIVE DISPOSITION TOWARD A... [2] THE COGNITIVE COMPONENT HOLDS BELIEFS AND KNOWLEDGE ABOUT... [3] THE AFFECTIVE COMPONENT CARRIES EMOTIONAL CHARGE, POSITIVE OR... [4] THE BEHAVIOURAL COMPONENT IS THE PREDISPOSITION TO ACT...

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. The ABC model: what attitude is made of
- [1] Attitude is a stable evaluative disposition toward a specific object.
- [2] The cognitive component holds beliefs and knowledge about the object.

MECHANISM

- [3] The affective component carries emotional charge, positive or negative.
- [4] The behavioural component is the predisposition to act toward the object.
- [5] Attitude is object-specific; value is general and cross-situational.
- [6] Belief is a single cognitive claim; attitude is an evaluative stance.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Aptitude is the trainable capacity to perform a role well.
- [8] The ABC model is associated with Rosenberg and Hovland, 1960.
- VERDICT → Attitude has three components; confusing it with value or aptitude costs marks.
- ANSWER USE → Open any attitude question by defining the ABC model and distinguishing it from value.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Attitude has three components; confusing it with value or aptitude costs marks.

01

STAGE 01 HOW ATTITUDES FORM: EXPERIENCE, LEARNING, REINFORCEMENT

HOW ATTITUDES FORM EXPERIENCE, LEARNING, REINFORCEMENT CENTRAL FOCUS 2. HOW ATTITUDES FORM [1] DIRECT EXPERIENCE WITH AN OBJECT CREATES THE STRONGEST... [2] SOCIAL LEARNING FROM FAMILY, PEERS AND MEDIA SHAPES... [3] REINFORCEMENT THROUGH REPEATED OUTCOMES ATTACHES EVALUATIVE CHARGE. [4] TWO OFFICERS IN THE SAME OFFICE CAN HOLD...

CENTRAL FOCUS

2. How attitudes form: experience, learning, reinforcement

[1] Direct experience with an object creates the strongest initial attitude.

[2] Social learning from family, peers and media shapes evaluative tendencies.

[3] Reinforcement through repeated outcomes attaches evaluative charge.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. How attitudes form: experience, learning, reinforcement
- [1] Direct experience with an object creates the strongest initial attitude.
- [2] Social learning from family, peers and media shapes evaluative tendencies.

MECHANISM

- [3] Reinforcement through repeated outcomes attaches evaluative charge.
- [4] Two officers in the same office can hold opposite attitudes toward the same community.
- [5] Formation explains attitude but does not justify it ethically.
- [6] Training can intervene at any formation pathway to reshape attitude.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] The affective component often resists change even when beliefs shift.
- [8] Institutional incentives can reinforce or corrode attitudes over time.
- VERDICT → Attitudes are formed, not born; understanding formation identifies training targets.
- ANSWER USE → Explain why attitudes differ before prescribing a change mechanism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — ANSWER USE → Explain why attitudes differ before prescribing a change mechanism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Attitudes are formed, not born; understanding formation identifies training targets.

02

STAGE 02 HOVLAND-YALE PERSUASION: SOURCE, MESSAGE, AUDIENCE, CHANNEL

HOVLAND-YALE PERSUASION SOURCE, MESSAGE, AUDIENCE, CHANNEL CENTRAL FOCUS 3. HOVLAND-YALE PERSUASION [1] THE COMMUNICATOR'S CREDIBILITY AND EXPERTISE DETERMINE SOURCE EFFECT. [2] THE MESSAGE'S CONTENT, FRAMING AND EMOTIONAL TONE SHAPE... [3] THE AUDIENCE'S PREDISPOSITIONS DETERMINE RESISTANCE OR OPENNESS. [4] THE CHANNEL OR MEDIUM WAS ADDED LATER FROM...

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Hovland-Yale persuasion: source, message, audience, channel

[1] The communicator's credibility and expertise determine source effect.

[2] The message's content, framing and emotional tone shape reception.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Hovland-Yale persuasion: source, message, audience, channel
- [1] The communicator's credibility and expertise determine source effect.
- [2] The message's content, framing and emotional tone shape reception.

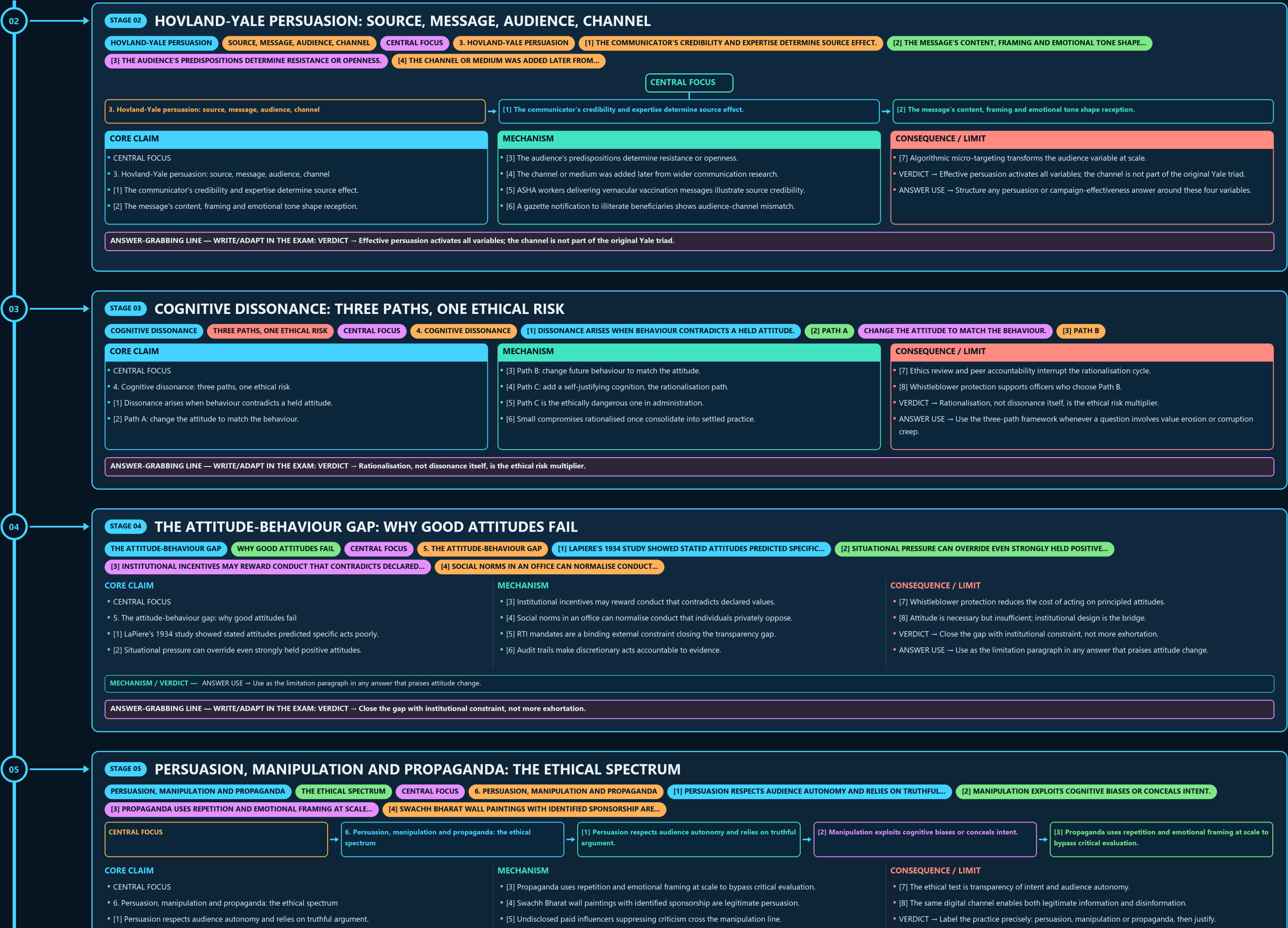
MECHANISM

- [3] The audience's predispositions determine resistance or openness.
- [4] The channel or medium was added later from wider communication research.
- [5] ASHA workers delivering vernacular vaccination messages illustrate source credibility.
- [6] A gazette notification to illiterate beneficiaries shows audience-channel mismatch.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Algorithmic micro-targeting transforms the audience variable at scale.
- VERDICT → Effective persuasion activates all variables; the channel is not part of the original Yale triad.
- ANSWER USE → Structure any persuasion or campaign-effectiveness answer around these four variables.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Effective persuasion activates all variables; the channel is not part of the original Yale triad.



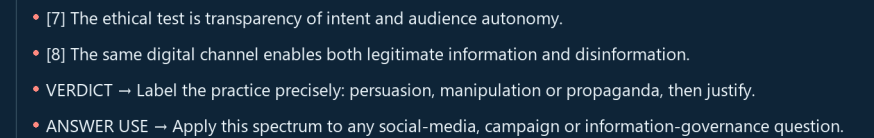
▼ ANSWER USE → Use as the limitation paragraph in any answer that praises attitude change.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Close the gap with institutional constraint, not more exhortation.

STAGE 05 PERSUASION, MANIPULATION AND PROPAGANDA: THE ETHICAL SPECTRUM

[2] MANIPULATION EXPLOITS COGNITIVE BIASES OR CONCEALS INTENT.

[4] SWACHH BHARAT WALL PAINTINGS WITH IDENTIFIED SPONSORSHIP ARE...



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Apply this spectrum to any social-media, campaign or information-governance question.

STAGE 06 MORAL ATTITUDE VERSUS POLITICAL ATTITUDE

[2] POLITICAL ATTITUDE EVALUATES PARTIES AND POWER CONTESTS; IT...

[5] NON-PARTISANSHIP COVERS OFFICIAL CONDUCT, NOT PRIVATE BELIEF OR...

- [7] Moral objection framed in law and public interest is principled dissent.
- VERDICT → Retain moral judgement; bracket political preference; distinguish duty from partisanship.
- ANSWER USE → Use whenever a question tests impartiality, neutrality or the limits of official conduct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Retain moral judgement; bracket political preference; distinguish duty from partisanship.

STAGE 07 POSITIVE VERSUS NEGATIVE MINDSET IN RULE INTERPRETATION

[2] A NEGATIVE MINDSET TREATS RULES AS OBSTACLES OR...

[5] POSITIVE INTERPRETATION ENABLES FAIR ACCESS WITHOUT IGNORING MANDATORY...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Read rules with purpose, apply with accountability, explain with reasons.

07

STAGE 07 POSITIVE VERSUS NEGATIVE MINDSET IN RULE INTERPRETATION

POSITIVE VERSUS NEGATIVE MINDSET IN RULE INTERPRETATION

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. POSITIVE VERSUS NEGATIVE MINDSET IN RULE INTERPRETATION

[1] A POSITIVE MINDSET READS RULES WITH THEIR PUBLIC...

[2] A NEGATIVE MINDSET TREATS RULES AS OBSTACLES OR...

[3] A FACILITATIVE OFFICER HELPS CORRECT A CURABLE DOCUMENT...

[4] A CYNICAL OFFICER EXPLOITS AMBIGUITY TO DEMAND INFORMAL...

[5] POSITIVE INTERPRETATION ENABLES FAIR ACCESS WITHOUT IGNORING MANDATORY...

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Positive versus negative mindset in rule interpretation
- [1] A positive mindset reads rules with their public purpose in view.
- [2] A negative mindset treats rules as obstacles or sources of discretionary power.

MECHANISM

- [3] A facilitative officer helps correct a curable document error.
- [4] A cynical officer exploits ambiguity to demand informal payment.
- [5] Positive interpretation enables fair access without ignoring mandatory conditions.
- [6] Negative interpretation produces delay, denial and extraction.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Stress amplifies the dominant mindset in crisis situations.
- [8] Purposive but accountable reading avoids both literalism and arbitrary benevolence.
- VERDICT → Read rules with purpose, apply with accountability, explain with reasons.
- ANSWER USE → Apply this dual-lens to any question about discretion, mindset or citizen-facing service.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Read rules with purpose, apply with accountability, explain with reasons.

08

STAGE 08 ATTITUDE MALLEABILITY: WILLIAM JAMES AND TRAINING DESIGN

ATTITUDE MALLEABILITY

WILLIAM JAMES AND TRAINING DESIGN

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. ATTITUDE MALLEABILITY

[1] THE MALLEABILITY PRINCIPLE HOLDS THAT ATTITUDES ARE REVISABLE...

[2] REFLECTION, FIELD IMMERSION AND MENTORING RESHAPE EVALUATIVE STANCES.

[3] MISSION KARMAYOGI MODULES TARGET COGNITIVE AND AFFECTIVE COMPONENTS.

[4] FOUNDATION-COURSE IMMERSION IN UNDERSERVED COMMUNITIES BUILDS EMPATHY.

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. Attitude malleability: William James and training design

[1] The malleability principle holds that attitudes are revisable, not fixed.

[2] Reflection, field immersion and mentoring reshape evaluative stances.

[3] Mission Karmayogi modules target cognitive and affective components.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Attitude malleability: William James and training design
- [1] The malleability principle holds that attitudes are revisable, not fixed.
- [2] Reflection, field immersion and mentoring reshape evaluative stances.

MECHANISM

- [3] Mission Karmayogi modules target cognitive and affective components.
- [4] Foundation-course immersion in underserved communities builds empathy.
- [5] Malleability is not victim-blaming: structural constraints need structural reform.
- [6] Periodic refresher training prevents cynicism and value erosion.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Provenance caution: the attributed William James sentence is not traceable to his writings.
- VERDICT → Attitudes can be changed; the change endures only with institutional reinforcement.
- ANSWER USE → Use for any question about training, attitude change, or the William James quotation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Attitudes can be changed; the change endures only with institutional reinforcement.

09

STAGE 09 INSTITUTIONAL CLOSURE: CODES, CONSTRAINTS AND THE RESIDUAL GAP

INSTITUTIONAL CLOSURE

CODES, CONSTRAINTS AND THE RESIDUAL GAP

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. INSTITUTIONAL CLOSURE

[1] PERSUASION-BASED REFORM IS SLOWER BUT MORE DURABLE ONCE...

[2] RULE-BASED CONSTRAINT IS FASTER BUT RISKS BOX-TICKING COMPLIANCE.

[3] CODE OF ETHICS TARGETS INTERNALISED COMMITMENT; CODE OF...

[4] RTI, AUDIT TRAILS AND WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTION ARE BINDING...

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. Institutional closure: codes, constraints and the residual gap

[1] Persuasion-based reform is slower but more durable once internalised.

[2] Rule-based constraint is faster but risks box-ticking compliance.

[3] Code of ethics targets internalised commitment; code of conduct targets external compliance.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Institutional closure: codes, constraints and the residual gap
- [1] Persuasion-based reform is slower but more durable once internalised.
- [2] Rule-based constraint is faster but risks box-ticking compliance.

MECHANISM

- [3] Code of ethics targets internalised commitment; code of conduct targets external compliance.
- [4] RTI, audit trails and whistleblower protection are binding constraints.
- [5] Training without institutional reform becomes a box-ticking exercise.
- [6] Institutional constraint without attitude change reverts when monitoring relaxes.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] The administrator must calibrate both strategies to the governance context.
- [8] Durable ethical conduct requires values contained within institutions.
- VERDICT → Neither persuasion alone nor constraint alone suffices; both must be calibrated together.
- ANSWER USE → Close any attitude-change answer with the institutional-closure qualification.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT → Neither persuasion alone nor constraint alone suffices; both must be calibrated together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Close any attitude-change answer with the institutional-closure qualification.

10

STAGE 10 TRAP DETECTION: WHAT COSTS MARKS IN ATTITUDE QUESTIONS

TRAP DETECTION

WHAT COSTS MARKS IN ATTITUDE QUESTIONS

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. TRAP DETECTION

[1] ATTITUDE AND VALUE ARE RELATED BUT NOT IDENTICAL

VALUE IS BROADER.

[2] POSITIVE ATTITUDE DOES NOT GUARANTEE ETHICAL BEHAVIOUR

GAP EXISTS.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
11. Trap detection: what costs marks in attitude questions
- [1] Attitude and value are related but not identical: value is broader.

MECHANISM

- [3] Persuasion is not inherently unethical: it depends on truthfulness.
- [4] Strong attitude does not always predict behaviour: situational override.
- [5] Dissonance is not always resolved ethically: rationalisation is common.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Channel is not part of the original Hovland-Yale 1953 triad.
- [8] Non-partisanship does not require enforced political blankness of mind.
- VERDICT → The trap is always an absolute claim where the correct position is qualified.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Institutional closure: codes, constraints and the residual gap
- [1] Persuasion-based reform is slower but more durable once internalised.
- [2] Rule-based constraint is faster but risks box-ticking compliance.

MECHANISM

- [3] Code of ethics targets internalised commitment; code of conduct targets external compliance.
- [4] RTI, audit trails and whistleblower protection are binding constraints.
- [5] Training without institutional reform becomes a box-ticking exercise.
- [6] Institutional constraint without attitude change reverts when monitoring relaxes.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] The administrator must calibrate both strategies to the governance context.
- [8] Durable ethical conduct requires values contained within institutions.
- VERDICT → Neither persuasion alone nor constraint alone suffices; both must be calibrated together.
- ANSWER USE → Close any attitude-change answer with the institutional-closure qualification.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT → Neither persuasion alone nor constraint alone suffices; both must be calibrated together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Close any attitude-change answer with the institutional-closure qualification.

10

STAGE 10

TRAP DETECTION: WHAT COSTS MARKS IN ATTITUDE QUESTIONS

TRAP DETECTION

WHAT COSTS MARKS IN ATTITUDE QUESTIONS

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. TRAP DETECTION

[1] ATTITUDE AND VALUE ARE RELATED BUT NOT IDENTICAL

VALUE IS BROADER.

[2] POSITIVE ATTITUDE DOES NOT GUARANTEE ETHICAL BEHAVIOUR

GAP EXISTS.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] Persuasion is not inherently unethical: it depends on truthfulness.	[7] Channel is not part of the original Hovland-Yale 1953 triad.
11. Trap detection: what costs marks in attitude questions	[4] Strong attitude does not always predict behaviour: situational override.	[8] Non-partisanship does not require enforced political blankness of mind.
[1] Attitude and value are related but not identical: value is broader.	[5] Dissonance is not always resolved ethically: rationalisation is common.	VERDICT → The trap is always an absolute claim where the correct position is qualified.
[2] Positive attitude does not guarantee ethical behaviour: gap exists.	[6] Persuasion and manipulation are not ethically identical: autonomy differs.	ANSWER USE → Scan each MCQ option for unqualified absolutes before selecting the answer.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Trap detection: what costs marks in attitude questions
- [1] Attitude and value are related but not identical: value is broader.
- [2] Positive attitude does not guarantee ethical behaviour: gap exists.

MECHANISM

- [3] Persuasion is not inherently unethical: it depends on truthfulness.
- [4] Strong attitude does not always predict behaviour: situational override.
- [5] Dissonance is not always resolved ethically: rationalisation is common.
- [6] Persuasion and manipulation are not ethically identical: autonomy differs.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Channel is not part of the original Hovland-Yale 1953 triad.
- [8] Non-partisanship does not require enforced political blankness of mind.
- VERDICT → The trap is always an absolute claim where the correct position is qualified.
- ANSWER USE → Scan each MCQ option for unqualified absolutes before selecting the answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The trap is always an absolute claim where the correct position is qualified.

11

STAGE 11

PYQ SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

PYQ SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. PYQ SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

[1] 2020 Q4(B) TESTED POSITIVE ATTITUDE UNDER STRESS

USE ABC MODEL AND CRISIS EXAMPLE.

[2] 2021 Q4(A) TESTED BUILDING SUITABLE ATTITUDE

USE FORMATION PATHWAYS AND TRAINING DESIGN.

[3] 2022 Q2(A) TESTED POSITIVE VERSUS NEGATIVE MINDSET

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. PYQ synthesis and answer architecture

[1] 2020 Q4(b) tested positive attitude under stress: use ABC model and crisis example.

[2] 2021 Q4(a) tested building suitable attitude: use formation pathways and training design.

[3] 2022 Q2(a) tested positive versus negative mindset: use dual-lens rule-interpretation frame.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. PYQ synthesis and answer architecture
- [1] 2020 Q4(b) tested positive attitude under stress: use ABC model and crisis example.
- [2] 2021 Q4(a) tested building suitable attitude: use formation pathways and training design.

MECHANISM

- [3] 2022 Q2(a) tested positive versus negative mindset: use dual-lens rule-interpretation frame.
- [4] 2025 Q3(b) tested William James malleability: use provenance caution and institutional support.
- [5] 2025 Q1(a) tested social-media ethics: use persuasion-at-scale and Hovland-Yale variables.
- [6] Define attitude via ABC before applying it to the scenario.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Always note the attitude-behaviour gap as a qualification.
- VERDICT → Every attitude answer moves from definition to mechanism, example, gap and institutional closure.
- ANSWER USE → Use as the final revision checklist before writing any GS-IV attitude answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Every attitude answer moves from definition to mechanism, example, gap and institutional closure.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. ARCHITECTURE

2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS

3. DETAILED TREATMENT

4. INSTITUTIONAL AND POLICY APPLICATION

5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES

6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS

7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

OPTIONAL ETHICAL DEPTH

- 1. Architecture
- 2. Concepts and distinctions
- 3. Detailed treatment
- 4. Institutional and policy application

ADVANCED LIMIT / TRADE-OFF

- 5. Indian applications and boundary cases
- 6. Limitations and trade-offs
- 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims
- 8. Advanced Prelims traps

ADMINISTRATIVE APPLICATION

- 9. Current application
- 10. PYQ-based analytical application
- 11. Mains-ready framework
- 12. Probable questions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.